

Constitution of Promoting Healthy Options Through Knowledge, Understanding,
and Service (PHOKUS)
Furman University

Article I

Name

The name of the organization shall be Promoting Healthy Options Through Knowledge, Understanding, and Service, hereafter known as PHOKUS.

Article II

Purpose of the Organization

Section One:

PHOKUS joins the Bacchus peer education network in order to provide primary prevention efforts to help alleviate the problem of alcohol misuse and abuse on campus, to promote responsible decisions about drinking within the campus community, to help educate and inform students, faculty, administrators, and staff about health issues that affect the campus community; including mental health, AIDS, tobacco awareness/cessation, fitness/nutrition, and sexual health; to increase awareness communication within the academic community regarding health-related matters of college students.

Section Two: Functions of PHOKUS

1. Be an educational resource for students to help them make healthy decisions for life.
2. Publicize the risk of destructive decisions for college students
3. Provide students with the best prevention and intervention tools possible to deal with college related health issues and destructive decisions

Article III

Membership

Section One:

Membership is open to all FU students who want to take a proactive role in being a peer educator and who have an interest in public and personal health and wellness.

Section Two: Responsibilities of PHOKUS Members

1. Attend PHOKUS meetings and all PHOKUS sponsored events
 - a. If a member is unable to attend a meeting or an event, he/she is required to clear the absence with the officers beforehand except in cases of emergency.
2. PHOKUS members are expected to follow through with any and all commitments made
3. Assist in campaigns and programming that will help educate students to make healthy decisions
4. Serve as a representative of Furman University by being aware of the decisions faced every day by college students
5. Be a committee member in at least one area if applicable
6. Perform other duties not otherwise noted
7. PHOKUS members that continually do not abide by the Membership Responsibilities are eligible for sanctions.

Section three: Expectations of PHOKUS members

1. Investment of time in PHOKUS activities by the following:

a. Meetings (mandatory) - 1 hour weekly meetings

- i. Every week, in the Health Services center. Changes may be made due to unexpected circumstances, but notifications will be given at least 2 days (48 hours) in advance.
- ii. Reminder emails will be sent via OrgSync after the Officers Meeting, with more detailed information if needed.
- iii. Be on time
 1. If you need to be late/leave early, you must notify the Vice President of Organization via email/text at least 24 hours prior to the meeting
 2. If prior notification cannot be given (i.e. in an emergency), leniency will be left to the discretion of the advisor and officers.
 3. Without notification, on multiple occasions, you must meet one-on-one with the officers.
- iv. **Allowed 3 Excused Absences per semester**
 1. The Vice President of Organization must be notified via email at least 24 hours prior to the meeting.
 2. Absences without prior notification will be marked as unexcused, but will be discussed in the weekly Officers Meeting and potentially re-identified as excused/unexcused.
 3. **More than one unexcused meeting absence** may result in termination of membership or ineligibility to continue in the next semester as an active member (at the discretion of the advisor and officers).
- v. Meeting discussions include signing up for shifts for events, activities, and dispensing promotional materials, etc.
- vi. Meeting also discusses campus activities. Be prepared to share activities in other groups.

b. Attend and support PHOKUS/Student Health Services

.All PHOKUS members are expected to volunteer their time to benefit the organization.

Volunteer activities can be spread across tabling events, CLP organizing, community service, health programming, and other activities.

i. Each member is expected to sign up for at least one portion of each event (promotion, organization, attendance at event). If you cannot attend the event, please sign up for promotional activities (banner painting/hanging, chalking, flyer making, flyer distribution, etc).

ii. Academics and your health come first: Email VPO if an extreme circumstance prevents you from attending a shift that you have signed up to volunteer for.

1. Academic absences - permission for an absence due to academic reason must be requested at least 2 days (48 hours) prior to the activity. However, it is your responsibility to find a replacement for your shift position!
2. Health absences - permission for an absence due to health reasons must be requested as soon as you know you will be unable to volunteer. If you think you are sick, please let us know and find a replacement as soon as possible.

- iii. It is your responsibility to fill your shift at least 2 days (48 hours) prior to your shift and report it to the VPO.
- iv. One unplanned/unexcused volunteer absence will result in a meeting with the officers to determine consequences.

2. Represent PHOKUS, Student Health Services, and Furman University as a professional

- . **PHOKUS members must wear PHOKUS attire when volunteering at an activity.**
 - . Failure to wear proper attire on one occasion will result in a warning. Two occasions will result in a meeting with the officers and advisor. Further occasions may result in further consequences at the discretion of the advisor.
- i. If wearing proper attire will keep a member from attending said event, it may be cleared with officers beforehand and excused.
- ii. Additional attire is available in the Student Health Services office, or may be borrowed from other members.
- iii. When simply attending a PHOKUS sponsored CLP, PHOKUS attire is strongly encouraged to be worn, but is not required.
- a. **Remember, you are not a counselor:** Refer students to campus resources as required, and do not attempt to diagnose a student. See additional information in your PHOKUS resources for referring students to Student Health Services or Student Counseling Services.

3. Be a Good Role Model:

- . **Social Media:**
 - . Posts on Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Snapchat, etc. in reference to PHOKUS must be respectful and positive.
- i. Posts by you in general should not be in conflict with the mission and vision of the Student Health Services and PHOKUS. Your profiles and posts should reflect positive health behaviors and promote the lifestyle you are educating students on.
- a. **At PHOKUS Events**
 - . Engage students in programs and activities **actively** and **consistently**
- i. Speak about positive health behaviors, rather than berate negative health behaviors
- ii. Remember confidentiality training! Any health information that a student shares with you should only be shared with the advisor.
- b. As role models and representatives of PHOKUS, students must adhere to campus policies and state and federal law. Members also must not engage in high-risk behaviors which include, but are not limited to, the following:
 - . Underage drinking or illegal drug use of any kind
 - ii. Driving under the influence of alcohol/drugs
- iii. Engaging in high risk sexual behavior

3. Communicate often and clearly with the advisor and each other

- . Program advisor will be available after weekly meetings and by appointment to talk about ideas, concerns, or even personal things you wish to discuss
- a. Reply to emails and text messages that are sent to you in a timely manner. If you do not reply, additional emails and text messages will be sent to make sure we reach everyone.

1. Contribute New Ideas, Opinions, and Suggestions

. Communicate with advisor and officers any ideas you have on any of the health topics we cover in PHOKUS

- a. If you have a new idea: share it!
- b. Submit suggestions anonymously at meetings or to the advisor/officers via email or in person.

2. Be Respectful

. **Of Time:** Be respectful of the advisor, officers, Student Health Services, and your fellow PHOKUS members' time. Show up at least 5 minutes early for all meetings, events, or volunteer times.

a. **In Attitude:** Please express concerns with club operations in private, with the advisor, president, or vice president. They will address the issue as needed and determine a course of action. Members that choose to express concerns or issues openly and unprofessionally with other members may result in termination of membership immediately at the discretion of advisor.

Article IV **Officers**

Section One:

_____The officers will provide leadership within PHOKUS and work closely with the PHOKUS advisor.

Section Two: Emergency Action

Members will take on emergency action, if necessary, on business brought before PHOKUS in the event a response to such business is needed before the next meeting of the entire organization. Each member must be contacted and informed of the response to such business before the response can be finalized.

Section Three: Officers

_____PHOKUS leadership will be comprised of a president (or co-presidents), vice president of organization, the treasurer, and a public relations chair, all of whom are current students at Furman University. PHOKUS is advised by a faculty or staff member of Furman University who will retain the title of PHOKUS advisor.

Section Four: Voting Privileges

All active members of PHOKUS, including officers (not including the advisor), will have voting privileges.

Article V

Qualifications and Duties of the PHOKUS Officers

Section One: Qualifications

PHOKUS Officers must have the following qualifications in order to reside in an officer position:

1. Be a current Furman University student
2. Regularly attend scheduled meetings and events (be in good attendance standing)
3. Promote/ participate in all PHOKUS events
4. Serve on committees when asked
5. Be a role model to other PHOKUS members, leading by example.

Section two: Duties

President(s)

1. Coordinate PHOKUS members for event planning to ensure organization's success
2. Assist in the planning and organization of PHOKUS events
3. Attend and lead all PHOKUS meetings
 - a. Including weekly officers meeting and full club meeting
4. Meet regularly with PHOKUS advisor
5. Oversee all committees and establish a communication system between the committees and the organization as a whole
6. Help recruit new PHOKUS members
7. Serve on the Pre-Health Student Group Council (or elect a representative to serve)
8. Attend all PHOKUS officers meetings

Vice President of Organization (VPO)

1. Maintain the OrgSync calendar of events
2. Take minutes and attendance at all meetings
3. Post minutes on OrgSync and Google Drive
4. Reserve rooms as needed via 25Live
5. Receive all absence excuses and alert members of unexcused absences
6. Attend all PHOKUS officers meetings

Treasurer

1. Control funds in PHOKUS SGA account (authorized to sign documents as treasurer, which serves as acknowledgement of his/her responsibility to ensure the balance remains at a positive cash balance)
2. Maintain budget in spreadsheet and discuss discrepancies regularly with advisor
3. Present budget items at PHOKUS meetings
4. Update president(s) and advisors on budget item status and any other needs.
5. Attend all PHOKUS officers meetings

Public Relations (PR)

1. Control, maintain, and keep active PHOKUS's social media accounts
2. Create new social media accounts as needed
3. Post passwords and usernames on GoogleDrive
4. Ensure all events have flyers, banners, and/or chalking created/printed/distributed by members
5. Post on each account at least once weekly
6. Create facebook events for each PHOKUS event/program and share with Furman Class of ___ facebook pages, personal page, etcetera.
7. Assist in ordering T-shirts and other promotional materials.
8. Promote PHOKUS across campus utilizing other means, always in a positive light.
9. Attend all PHOKUS officers meetings

PHOKUS Advisor

1. Be a role model for PHOKUS members

2. Understand PHOKUS mission and function to act as a resource for information regarding the areas of wellness, health and behavior that PHOKUS covers.
3. Help to clearly explain PHOKUS's philosophy and mission to interested students, staff, and faculty who would like to become more involved within PHOKUS
4. Empower PHOKUS members to set and achieve goals and objectives
5. Help members make decisions about policy and procedures
6. Act as a liaison between administration and PHOKUS
7. Attend all officers meetings if possible and all weekly meetings

Section four: Removal of an Officer

Removal of a PHOKUS officer from his/her position is a serious step and should be taken only after certifying the accusations and having an in depth discussion among all concerned. If the person violates the requirements and expectations of a PHOKUS officer, he/she shall be eligible to be removed from the officer position, not PHOKUS as a whole. Contacting the Student Government Association can assist the club in making this decision/transition, and they can also assist in reporting behavior to the Student Conduct Board, if necessary.

If the person removed is the president, another officer or advisor shall run the meeting. The presiding person shall ensure that all discussions are respectful and constructive, maintaining privacy and confidentiality.

Process of removal:

1. PHOKUS member shall make a motion in an officers meeting to remove a person from his/her leadership position and provide the reasons (facts) behind the motion.
2. A second PHOKUS member needs to make the same motion.
3. Rebuttal (in person or via written statement) from the person being removed.
4. Discussion on the situation and the matter at hand shall proceed with all officers and members actively participating. The officer in question shall be removed from the room during this time.
5. To be removed, there needs to be a $\frac{3}{4}$ majority vote (75%),

Section Five: Resignation of an Executive Board Member

If an officer resigns or is removed during the school year, the advisor and remaining officers shall appoint a replacement to complete the remainder of the predecessor's term. It is recommended that the resigning officer give the PHOKUS advisor and fellow officers at least one week notice.

Section Six: Election of Officers

1. The elected positions shall be decided upon via open vote by a simple majority vote of active members.
2. The election takes place at the end of the academic year, at least one month prior to the last day of class to ensure a proper transitional phase.
3. There no limit to the number of nominees per position.
4. At least one month prior to the election, the club must be given notice of the upcoming election and provided descriptions for each available officer position.
5. All officer positions are to be voted on during elections, no exceptions.

6. The year prior's co-president has the first opportunity to continue in that position, with one other co-president being elected to serve along side him/her. If the former co-president does not wish to continue his/her duties as co-president or is removed from his/her position, two co-presidents will be elected.
7. After elections conclude, both incoming and outgoing officers for each position must attend the weekly officers meetings until the end of the academic year.

Section Seven: Order of Succession

____ Succession of power in case of removal and/or resignation of an officer:

1. President(s)
2. Vice President of Organization
3. Treasurer
4. Public Relations
5. Committee Chairs
6. PHOKUS members

ARTICLE VI

Meetings

Section one:

1. There will be at least one PHOKUS meeting per month, with weekly meetings being the norm. Public notice of the meeting must be made at least 24 hours prior.
2. All active members (excluding the PHOKUS advisor) shall have voting privileges.
3. There will also be an officers meeting at least once monthly, with weekly or bi-weekly meetings being the norm.
4. Meetings shall be purposeful and fun. Agenda shall be prepared prior to the meeting, attendance shall be taken at all meetings, and meeting minutes shall be posted to the Google Drive or OrgSync in a timely manner.

Article VII

Amendments

____ Proposed amendments must be presented to the PHOKUS officers in writing during a regularly scheduled officers meeting. The amendment shall be discussed and then tabled until the next regularly scheduled meeting, during which time the officers will seek the opinion of PHOKUS members. Members shall vote on the amendment. A simple majority vote is required to ratify the amendment (51%).